

Fringelsland — Rebuilding The Hub

A plain-language guide to the plan & every area's inner components · 28 June 2026

Fringelsland is an edutainment platform for group-based personal development, built around three questions: *Who am I? What do I want? How do I get there?* **The Hub** is its first surface — the web app people and groups use. We are rebuilding it cleanly ("v2"): an earlier prototype proved the idea but broke the architecture we've since designed, so we keep the proven database underneath and rebuild the app on top, one area at a time, always keeping a working product.

1 · The journey in five phases

Phase	What it does	Status
0 · Decide	Lock the decision to rebuild rather than patch	Done
1 · Aim	Refresh the target spec; audit what the database already gives us; catalogue the old behaviours	Done
2 · Foundation	A thin end-to-end "walking skeleton" done the right way (sign in → see your groups)	Done
3 · Build area by area	Build each part of the Hub in dependency order, one area at a time	Active — first area
4 · Cut over	Once every area is rebuilt, switch over and retire the old app	Upcoming

2 · The eight areas, in build order

An **area** is a family of related things a person can do. Phase 3 builds them in **dependency order** — the things everything else needs come first. Each area is made of small numbered **capabilities** (one capability = one thing a person can do). 106 in total.

Area	In plain words	Size	Where it sits
Identity (A-IDN)	Who you are: arriving, signing up, profile, consent, account, leaving	12	Active now
Groups (A-GRP)	The groups you belong to, your role, joining and leaving	19	Next
Journeys (A-JRN)	The structured experiences you travel through	18	Then
Communication (A-COM)	Messages, forums, announcements	15	Then
Notifications (A-NTF)	Being told — and acting on — things that matter	10	Then
Platform Operations (A-ADM)	Behind-the-scenes admin that keeps the platform healthy	18	Then
Companion & Insight (A-COI)	Your AI inner-voice companion (the Whisp) & private insight	7	Later — needs AI engines first
Discovery (A-DIS)	Finding journeys, groups and people	7	Later — needs search engine first

How to read the dependency columns

Capabilities lean on shared platform pieces (built underneath the screens). In plain terms: **Identity** (accounts/sessions/profile), **Groups** (memberships/roles/permissions), **Governance** (consent/audit/policy), **Infrastructure** (realtime/stats); plus domain engines: **Journeys engine**, **Content**, **Messaging**, **Discovery/search**, **Intelligence** (the Whisp's AI). A **Cross-area** note flags where one area's capability reaches into *another area* — the dependencies you specifically asked about (e.g. account deletion reaching into Groups + Journeys).

3 · The active area: Identity (A-IDN — 12)

The four capabilities everything else depends on are **done**; eight remain.

ID	What it means	Depends on	Status
IDN-1	Arrive anonymously, no sign-up (the "Mist")	Identity, Groups (proto group)	Done
IDN-2	Turn an anonymous visit into a real account — or say goodbye & be erased	IDN-1; Identity, Groups, Governance. Cross-area: Journeys (carry over in-flight enrolment)	Done
IDN-3	Lasting member identity: sign in, sign out, stay signed in	IDN-2; Identity	Done
IDN-4	See/edit profile (name, display name, bio, visibility) + account menu	IDN-3; Identity, Groups (display name ↔ group name)	Done
IDN-9	See your account state (active / deactivated / closed)	IDN-3; Identity, Governance	Cycle A
IDN-12	Reactivate your own account	IDN-9; Identity, Governance	Cycle A
IDN-6	See your consent state and its history	IDN-3; Governance	Cycle B
IDN-7	Change consent & fine-grained sharing controls	IDN-6; Governance, Groups	Cycle B
IDN-8	Request & download a full data export	IDN-3; Governance	Cycle C
IDN-5	A private personal Journal only you can see	IDN-3; Identity (Journal store)	Cycle D
IDN-11	See your devices & sign out of others remotely	IDN-3; Identity (session inventory)	Cycle E
IDN-10	Delete / leave the platform	IDN-3, IDN-9; Identity, Governance, Groups. Cross-area: Groups (membership cascade), Journeys (freeze enrolments), Communication (forum content)	Cycle F · deferred

Build order (each "cycle" = one focused slice): A account-state → B consent → C export → D Journal → E devices → F deletion (deferred). See the deletion callout at the end for why F waits.

4 · Groups & Belonging (A-GRP — 19)

Groups are the primary social container — create, configure and inhabit groups, manage membership and roles, and leave gracefully (multiple lifecycle paths so nothing is destroyed needlessly).

ID	What it does	Depends on / cross-area links
GRP-1	Create an engagement group (creator becomes Steward)	Identity; Groups
GRP-2	Edit group settings (name, description, branding)	GRP-1; Groups
GRP-3	Configure group & member-list visibility independently	GRP-1; Groups
GRP-4	Show your group list & the group detail view	Identity; Groups. Cross-area: Journeys (enrolment summary in detail)
GRP-5	Show group lifecycle status (active / closed / archived / suspended)	GRP-1; Groups
GRP-6	Apply role templates & define custom roles in a group	GRP-1; Groups
GRP-7	Manage member roles (assign / remove / change)	GRP-1, GRP-6; Groups
GRP-8	"Act as" context selector + effective permissions for the current actor	GRP-4; Groups (permission resolution)
GRP-9	Delete an engagement group (Steward action)	GRP-1, GRP-7; Groups. Cross-area: Journeys (freeze enrolments), Communication (forum disposition)
MEM-1	Invite an existing member (with member search)	GRP-1, GRP-6; Groups. Cross-area: Discovery (member search)
MEM-2	Invite a non-member by email (auto-claim on signup)	GRP-1, GRP-6; Groups, Identity (auto-claim), Notifications (email)
MEM-3	Accept or decline an invitation	MEM-1/MEM-2; Groups
MEM-4	Pause or re-activate a member's participation	GRP-6; Groups
MEM-5	Remove a member from a group (Steward action)	GRP-6; Groups. Cross-area: Journeys (freeze enrolment)
MEM-6	Leave a group voluntarily (regular)	Identity, GRP-4; Groups. Cross-area: Journeys (freeze), Communication (former-member attribution)
MEM-7	Leave with leadership handover (sole-leader / nominated succession)	GRP-4, GRP-7, MEM-6; Groups, Notifications. Cross-area: Journeys, Platform-Ops (DeusEx fallback)
MEM-8	Last-member group closure with content reassignment	MEM-6; Groups. Cross-area: Journeys (mass freeze), Communication (forum preservation), Content (asset disposition)
MEM-9	Show "former member" attribution after exit	MEM-5/6/7/8, GRP-9; Groups. Cross-area: Communication (content authorship)
MEM-10	A group joins another group (group-of-groups)	GRP-1, GRP-6; Groups (deep resolution — open question)

5 · Journeys (A-JRN — 18)

Journeys are the primary developmental experience. The Hub renders them (player, catalogue, progress); the narrative content and step rules live in the Journeys engine + Content.

ID	What it does	Depends on / cross-area links
JRN-1	Browse the journey catalogue	Cross-area: Discovery (catalogue), Journeys engine
JRN-2	View a journey's detail	JRN-1; Journeys engine, Content (preview)
JRN-3	Enrol yourself in a journey	Identity, JRN-2; Journeys engine, Groups (personal group enrolls)
JRN-4	Enrol a whole group in a journey	Cross-area: Groups (GRP-1, GRP-8); Journeys engine
JRN-5	Keep an in-flight enrolment when an anonymous visit becomes an account	Cross-area: Identity (IDN-2); Journeys engine
JRN-6	Render the journey player	JRN-3/JRN-4; Journeys engine, Content
JRN-7	Walk steps (previous / next)	JRN-6; Journeys engine
JRN-8	Mark a step complete + enforce required-step gating	JRN-6; Journeys engine
JRN-9	Auto-save progress on every action	JRN-6; Journeys engine
JRN-10	Resume from your last position	JRN-9; Journeys engine
JRN-11	Track per-step and total time	JRN-6; Journeys engine
JRN-12	Detect journey completion when all required steps are done	JRN-8; Journeys engine
JRN-13	Review mode for completed journeys	JRN-12; Journeys engine, Content
JRN-14	Read-only "frozen enrolment" mode with explanation	JRN-6; Cross-area: Groups (the member-exit cluster), Journeys engine
JRN-15	Detect first arrival & auto-launch a designated journey	Identity; Journeys engine
JRN-16	Show group-level progress (role-gated)	JRN-4; Cross-area: Groups (GRP-8); Journeys engine
JRN-17	Show per-member progress in a group (role-gated, privacy-respecting)	JRN-4; Cross-area: Groups, Governance (visibility consent); Journeys engine
JRN-18	Render every step type the engine publishes	JRN-6; Journeys engine, Content

6 · Communication & Community (A-COM — 15)

One-to-one messages, group forums, and one-to-many announcements, delivered in real time, with graceful handling of authorship across membership changes.

ID	What it does	Depends on / cross-area links
COM-1	Send a direct message to another member	Identity; Messaging, Groups (personal group as author)
COM-2	Show the conversation inbox	COM-1; Messaging
COM-3	Show a conversation with full history	COM-2; Messaging
COM-4	Track per-conversation read state	COM-3; Messaging
COM-5	Show a group forum	Cross-area: Groups (GRP-1, GRP-8); Messaging
COM-6a	Post a top-level forum message (role-gated)	COM-5; Messaging, Groups
COM-6b	Reply to a forum message (role-gated)	COM-5, COM-6a; Messaging, Groups
COM-7	Moderate forum content (Steward)	COM-5/6a/6b; Messaging, Groups
COM-8	Steward announcement to a group (1→many)	Cross-area: Groups (GRP-8); Messaging, Notifications
COM-9	Platform-wide admin announcement (1→all)	Cross-area: Platform-Ops; Messaging, Notifications
COM-10	Real-time updates for messages, posts & activity	COM-1, COM-5; Messaging, Infrastructure (realtime)
COM-11	Reconcile missed messages on reconnect	COM-10; Messaging
COM-12	Edit/delete your own message within a window	COM-1/6a/6b; Messaging
COM-13	Report content from a forum or DM	COM-3/6a/6b; Messaging, Governance. Cross-area: Platform-Ops (moderation queue)
COM-14	Show former-member attribution at display time	Cross-area: Groups (MEM-9); Messaging

7 · Notifications & Inbox (A-NTF — 10)

The connective tissue — render notifications, let the member act on "smart" ones directly, reconcile missed events, and configure preferences.

ID	What it does	Depends on / cross-area links
NTF-1	Receive & render passive notifications	Identity; Messaging, Notifications
NTF-2	Notification bell with unread count	NTF-1; Notifications
NTF-3	Notification inbox / history	NTF-1; Notifications
NTF-4	Receive & render smart (actionable) notifications	NTF-1; Notifications, Messaging
NTF-5	Typed-action UI (Accept/Decline, etc.)	NTF-4; Notifications
NTF-6	Submit a response & dispatch to the right handler	NTF-5; Governance. Cross-area: Groups (stewardship transfer), Groups (invitation accept), Communication (moderation reply)
NTF-7	Track per-notification read state	NTF-1; Notifications
NTF-8	Lazily resolve expired smart notifications on view	NTF-4; Notifications
NTF-9	Reconcile missed notifications on reconnect	NTF-1; Notifications, Messaging, Infrastructure (realtime)
NTF-10	Configure notification preferences (per category & channel)	Cross-area: Identity (IDN-7 consent); Notifications, Governance

8 · Platform Operations (A-ADM — 18, admin overlay)

Behind-the-scenes operations for the platform's *DeusEx* administrators. This is a "meta-area" — it serves members indirectly by keeping the platform healthy. Many actions are admin overrides that route *through* the same lifecycle paths the member-facing areas use.

ID	What it does	Depends on / cross-area links
ADM-1	Admin dashboard with platform statistics	GRP-8; Infrastructure (stats), Groups, Governance
ADM-2	Search/filter/list members platform-wide	ADM-1; Groups, Discovery (search)
ADM-3	Activate / deactivate / decommission an account	ADM-2; Identity, Governance
ADM-4	Hard-delete a member, reassign content to a sentinel author	ADM-2; Identity, Groups, Governance. Cross-area: Journeys (cleanup), Communication (reassignment)
ADM-5	Force-logout a member's sessions	ADM-2; Identity, Notifications
ADM-6	Sweep a member from every group	Cross-area: Groups (MEM-5/6/7/8); Identity, Governance, Journeys, Communication
ADM-7	Bulk-action selected members (safe subset)	ADM-2; Groups, Governance
ADM-8	Group administration view (all groups)	ADM-1; Groups
ADM-9	Suspend / reassign / reactivate a group platform-wide	ADM-8, GRP-5; Groups
ADM-10	Content-moderation queue (reports across the platform)	Cross-area: Communication (COM-13); Governance
ADM-11	Triage & resolve content reports (with action dispatch)	ADM-10; Governance. Cross-area: Communication, Groups
ADM-12	Manage admin membership (last-admin protection)	ADM-1; Groups
ADM-13	Auto-grant verification view (filtered audit log)	ADM-16; Groups, Governance
ADM-14	Configure platform policy (versioned, reversible)	ADM-1; Governance
ADM-15	Manage feature flags (create / toggle / scope)	ADM-1; Governance
ADM-16	Platform-scope audit-log surface	ADM-1; Governance
ADM-17	Manage role templates & the permission catalogue	ADM-1, ADM-13; Groups
ADM-18	Remove members from specific group(s) platform-wide (DeusEx override of MEM-5)	ADM-2, ADM-8; Cross-area: Groups (MEM-5/7/8), Governance, Journeys, Communication

9 · Later areas (build once their engines exist)

Companion & Insight (A-COI — 7)

The member's **Whisp** — their AI-driven inner-voice companion (experienced as one's own inner voice, not an external bot). Universal and always voluntary. Built once the Intelligence + World-Model engines are consumed (after Ferd).

ID	What it does	Depends on
COI-1	Configure Whisp engagement & consent	Identity (IDN-7); Intelligence, Governance
COI-2	Per-context engagement preferences (per journey step)	COI-1; Intelligence, Governance
COI-3	Whisp's dialogic presence inside a journey step	Cross-area: Journeys (JRN-6); Intelligence
COI-4	Standalone Whisp dialogue surface	COI-1; Intelligence
COI-5	Reset/delete the Whisp's accumulated memory (real deletion)	COI-1; Intelligence, Governance
COI-6	Private Whisp reflective view (member-only)	Identity; Intelligence
COI-7	Private insight portrait (longer reflective narrative)	Cross-area: Journeys; Intelligence, Governance

Discovery & Direction-Finding (A-DIS — 7)

Surfaces for finding journeys, groups and people; the search/ranking logic lives in the Discovery engine. Built once that engine is consumed.

ID	What it does	Depends on
DIS-1	Journey catalogue surface	Journeys engine, Discovery (ranking)
DIS-2	Group browse surface (public groups)	Cross-area: Groups (GRP-3 visibility); Discovery
DIS-3	Member-search surface (opted-in members only)	DIS-6; Discovery, Groups (consent filtering)
DIS-4	Recommendations surface (opt-in, explained)	Identity (IDN-7); Discovery, Intelligence
DIS-5	"Why this recommendation" explanation	DIS-4; Discovery, Intelligence
DIS-6	Configure your own discoverability defaults	Identity (IDN-7); Groups, Governance
DIS-7	Activity feed (aggregated ambient surface)	Cross-area: Groups, Communication; Discovery

10 · The cross-area dependencies at a glance

These are the places one area reaches into another — the kind of dependency you flagged with account deletion. They are handled in the shared platform underneath, so they don't force us to build areas out of order; they do tell us where a capability can only be *fully* finished once a later area lands.

Dependency	What it means
Account deletion → Groups, Journeys, Communication (IDN-10)	Erasing an account must drop group memberships, freeze journey enrolments, and dispose of forum content. The deferred one — see the callout below.
Becoming a member → Journeys (IDN-2 ↔ JRN-5)	If you started a journey anonymously, it carries over when you sign up. <i>Already handled (both done).</i>
Leaving / removing from a group → Journeys, Communication (MEM-5/6/7/8, GRP-9)	Any group exit freezes the member's enrolments and re-attributes their forum content ("former member"). The Journeys "frozen mode" (JRN-14) is the member-facing half.
Journeys → Groups (JRN-4, JRN-16/17)	Group enrolment and group/per-member progress need the group's roles & permissions.
Forums & announcements → Groups (COM-5/6/7/8)	Forums live inside groups and are gated by group roles; Steward announcements need group context.
Smart notifications → everywhere (NTF-6)	Acting on a notification dispatches into the owning area — accept an invite (Groups), stewardship transfer (Groups), moderation reply (Communication).
Discovery → Groups, Identity (DIS-2/3/7)	Browsing groups/people respects group visibility and each member's opt-in sharing.
Admin overrides → member-facing lifecycles (ADM-4/6/18, COM-9, COM-13→ADM-10)	DeusEx removals route <i>through</i> the same group-exit paths members use; reports flow from Communication into the moderation queue.

The deferred dependency: deleting your account (IDN-10)

Why it's special. Erasing an account isn't only an Identity action — it must ripple into Groups (drop memberships), Journeys (freeze enrolments) and Communication (forum content).

Why it doesn't block us. That ripple runs *underneath* the app, in the shared database (an automatic cascade with safety rules), not by one screen driving another. Much of it already exists from the old system and carries forward — so the Groups/Journeys *screens* are not prerequisites.

Why we still defer it. The fully up-to-date cascade leans on the Journeys and forum engines, which come online when we build those *later* areas. So deletion finishes in two natural steps: the enrolment part once **Journeys** lands, the final piece once **Communication** lands.

How it's tracked (so it isn't forgotten). Anchored to the events that unblock it: a parked spec our health-check flags the moment its blocker clears; an explicit "what's left" cascade document; re-entry reminders attached to the Journeys and Communication areas; and an entry in the cross-cutting gaps register.

11 · What happens next

Two alternating session types, a step ahead on planning: **plan a cycle** (write the ready-to-build spec for both the screen and the platform piece under it), then **build a cycle** (platform piece first, then the screen, test-first, until shipped). Immediate next step: **plan Cycle A** (account state + reactivation). After Identity, we move to **Groups** — the social foundation that unlocks Journeys, Communication and Discovery — then onward in the order above, finishing account deletion along the way, ending with the cut-over to the new Hub.

